Safe System of Work
Maintenance in Trailer Bodies

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Overview

The following information provides guidance on the company's Standard Operation Procedures for entering and working in trailer bodies.

All employees have a responsibility for their safety and the safety of others by adhering to these codes of practice.

Hazards Identified

- Respiratory
- Vehicle movements
- Falls from height
- Manual handling
- Crushing
- Slips & Trips
- Explosion

Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) Requirements










This document provides guidance on the measures necessary to perform maintenance inside the skip area of tipping and waling floor trailers.

Cleaning of wagon skips will depend on the types of goods carried and the residues remaining.

Grain and other food/animal stuffs transported under the TASCC scheme are subject to strict rules and regulatory control. The cleaning regimes are stipulated by the IDTF (International Database Transport for Feed) and must be carried out after each load is carried.

If unsure, visit www.icrt-idtf.com and enter the transported material in the search box. It will take you straight to the page containing the cleaning requirements for that load.

Safety Precautions

- All wheels must be chocked before entering skip.
- Park wagon away from any loading areas, to avoid unintentional loading occurring while in skip bed.
- Park on flat, level ground, in an area of sufficient lighting, and away from any access/egress points.
- Always observe site traffic management plans (where provided).
- Never block emergency access routes.
- 5-point PPE (gloves, boots, hat, hi-vis, goggles) must worn when performing task. Mask may also be required, depending on the material residue remaining (this will be identified in the risk assessment).
- Remove keys and keep on person, to prevent third party moving vehicle with operative in skip area.
- Inspect steps and handles before use. Any damage must be reported immediately.
- Access will be gained via steps built into skip body.
- Where this is not possible, suitable, certificated ladders will be used to gain entry at wagon manufacturer's designated entry point.
- NEVER prop open the rear gate of a skip bed, unless there is a built-in prop system that has been fitted.
- NEVER gain entry through the rear gate – always use integral steps or approved ladders at the correct entry points.
- To visually inspect a skip bed, use inspection hatches, or climb the integral steps to view.
- Always maintain three points of contact when climbing any ladder system.
- Always carry a mobile phone on your person, to ensure you can call for help or contact emergency services.

Dust

Dust is dangerous to health and is covered by the Control of Substances Hazardous to Health (**COSHH**) Regulations.
Dust can cause irritation to eyes, skin and the respiratory system.

The Workplace Exposure Limit (**WEL**) of silica dust is:

0.1mg per m3 over 8-hour time-weighted average (TWA)

The Workplace Exposure Limit (**WEL**) of asphalt dust is:

5mg per m3 over 8-hour time-weighted average (TWA)
10mg per m3 over 15 minutes

Masks and goggles MUST be worn at all times when sweeping out.

The COSHH assessment and associated HSE Guidance Note will provide comprehensive detail on the effects of each dust on your health.

Operatives must **NEVER smoke** while sweeping out trailers.